

## Playlist Menu

The Playlist menu button  has options and commands for managing the Playlist.

- **Edit** - Many of these functions can be accessed using the Edit Tool icons along the top of the Playlist window.
  - **Cut (Ctrl+X)** - Cuts all selected pattern bars and Audio Clips to the clipboard.
  - **Copy (Ctrl+C)** - Copies all selected pattern bars and Audio Clips to the clipboard.
  - **Paste (Ctrl+V)** - Pastes pattern bars and Audio Clips from the clipboard.
  - **Duplicate (Ctrl+B)** - Duplicate the selection to the right of the current location. If no selection is made all patterns are duplicated.
  - **Delete (Del)** - Deletes all selected pattern bars and Audio Clips. If no selection is made deletes all pattern bars and Audio Clips.
  - **Shift left / right (Shift+Left-arrow) / (Shift+Right-arrow)** - Shifts the current selection left / right by 1 snap-unit.
  - **Shift up / down (Shift+Up-arrow) / (Shift+Down-arrow)** - Shifts current selection up / down by 1 track. If no selection is made all patterns are moved.
  - **Allow resizing from the left (Ctrl+Alt/Opt+Home)** - Allows the start of Clips to be resized from the left (Clip start). NOTE: There must be data to the left of the Clip start for resizing to work, this is why it's called resizing not extending.
  - **Nudge clips with mouse wheel (Shift+Mouse-Wheel)** - Clips will move when the Mouse pointer is over the Clip, (Shift) is held and the Mouse-Wheel rolled. Movement will be according to the PPQ settings. When deselected (default), the shortcut is (Shift+Alt/Opt+Mouse-Wheel).
  - **Dropping on track header locks to content** - When locked to content the track will insert/paint the Clip that it is locked to.
  - **Drop audio on track headers** - Associated with [Track Mode assignment](#). Choose between the following options:
    - **As audio clips** - The Playlist Track will be renamed to match the Audio file and an Audio Clip will be added to the Track. No other associations are made, this replicates default behavior prior to FL Studio 20.
    - **As audio tracks** - The Playlist Track and auto-assigned Mixer Track are named to match the Audio file. The Audio Clip is also added to the Playlist Track. Subsequent audio files dropped on the Playlist Track will be auto-routed to the associated Mixer Track. TIP: Hold (Shift) to prevent the Channel Editor from opening.

- As instrument tracks - The Playlist Track, auto-assigned Mixer Track and Pattern will be named to match the Audio file. The Pattern will be added to the Playlist Track. The audio will be added to the Channel Rack as a Sampler Channel. This is useful when sequencing percussion, for example.
- Always ask - An annoying pop-up will offer the options above, each time audio files are dropped on the Track Headers. This will be confusing as you won't remember what the options do. You will learn to hate the pop-up and start using the options above to suit your workflow preferences.
- Mute / Unmute - Mute (silence) or un-mute the selected Clips/s or Clip groups.
- Insert space (Ctrl+Ins) - Creates an empty space that matches the current selection (Ctrl+Click-and-drag) on the bar numbers at the top of the Playlist) by shifting all the following Pattern Clips forward.
- Slice and insert space (Ctrl+Alt/Opt+Ins) - Slices at the start of the current selection and moves the sliced Clips to the end of the current selection.
- Delete space (Ctrl+Del) - Erases all patterns in the current selection and shifts Clips to the right of the deleted section, left to close the gap.
- Merge pattern clips (Ctrl+G) - Merges the selected Pattern Clips into a single Clip.
- Merge similar pattern clips (Shift+Ctrl+G) - As above, but merges similar repetitions everywhere in the Playlist. NOTE: The process creates a new 'merged' Pattern, the original Patterns still exist.  [Video Here](#)
- Merge automation clips (Ctrl+Alt/Opt+G) - Merges selected Automation Clips. Where the Clips are on different Playlist Tracks, the first (left-most) Automation Clip in the group will be used as the starting point for the new Automation Clip. The pop-up dialog will ask for link preferences:
  - Keep links of the first selected clip - The target/s of the first Automation Clip (left-most) will be automated.
  - Merge all links - All targets from all Automation Clips will be automated.
  - Delete all links - All targets will be forgotten. The Automation Clip will need to be re-linked.
  - Pitch selected audio clips one semitone down (7) - The semitone change is applied to the Pitch knob in the [Clip Properties](#) using the Stretch Mode selected in the [Channel Sampler Settings](#).
  - Pitch selected audio clips one semitone up (8) - The semitone change is applied to the Pitch knob in the [Clip Properties](#) using the Stretch Mode selected in the [Channel Sampler Settings](#).

- Reverse selected audio clips (9) - The reverse option is applied to the Reverse setting in the [Clip Properties](#).
- Automatic crossfades - See [Project Settings > Playlist](#).
- Create new clips with manual fades - Set all newly created Audio Clips with a manual [Crossfade](#) setting.
- Snap fade handles - Fade handles move and snap to the Playlist grid (snap setting).
- Tools.
  - Quick quantize start times (Ctrl+Q) - Aligns all selected patterns to the snap setting set in the (  ) Snap Selector.
  - Consolidate playlist selection - Converts the selected Pattern and Audio Clip/s to a single Audio Clip and mutes the source Clips. The consolidated Audio Clip is routed to the Master Mixer Channel. By default, all Channel Instruments / Audio Clips are captured through their respective Mixer Channels including FX, but without Master FX (so the Master FX are not applied twice). If necessary, you can change these settings on the [Render Dialog pop-up](#) that appears to confirm the action. There are two length options:
    - From selection start (Ctrl+Alt/Opt+C) - Creates an Audio Clip starting at the first selected Clip or Timeline selection to the last selected Clip end.
    - From song start (Shift+Ctrl+Alt/Opt+C) - Creates an Audio Clip starting from the beginning of the Playlist. Use this method when you are creating song-length 'stems' to share with other projects, as there will be no confusion where the Clip/s should be placed (at the start of Bar 1).

NOTE: You can use this feature to merge several vocal or instrumental recordings into a single Audio Clip, or to reduce CPU load.

- Export all playlist tracks - Sequentially renders each Playlist track to an audio file. NOTE: See the section on '[Bouncing to Audio / Freezing](#)' for full details on this feature. There are some caveats associated with Mixer Effects rendering as expected. Sub-options include:
  - From song start - Create an audio track for each Playlist track from the start of the Playlist.
  - From track start - Create an audio track for each Playlist track from the start of the data in the Playlist Track. This will result in uneven length 'stems' (files).

- Time selection - Create an audio track for each Playlist for the selected time range.
- Export all playlist track groups - Same as the above, but creates only one WAV file for Grouped Playlist Tracks (the parent and sub-track audio is combined). NOTE: See the section on '[Bouncing to Audio / Freezing](#)' for full details on this feature. There are some caveats associated with Mixer Effects rendering as expected. Sub-options include:
  - From song start - Create an audio track for each Playlist track from the start of the Playlist.
  - From track start - Create an audio track for each Playlist track from the start of the data in the Playlist Track. This will result in uneven length 'stems' (files).
  - Time selection - Create an audio track for each Playlist for the selected time range.
- Clone selected playlist track(s) (Shift/Cmd+B) - Duplicate existing Playlist track, with the option to clone Patterns, Audio Clips, Automation, Effects (in linked Mixer tracks) and Grouped Playlist Tracks.
- View - Change the way the Clips and Playlist appear.
  - Grid Color(Ctrl+Alt/Opt+G) - Opens a dialog box that lets you choose a color for the Playlist grid.
  - Grid contrast - Choose High, Medium or Low contrast for the Grid.
  - Invert grid - Changes the Playlist bar-grid lines from light to dark.
  - Track separators - Track separators are the horizontal lines separating Clip Tracks when this switch is selected.
  - Time segments - Change the Playlist background shading to represent time-periods according to the option selected. The default is 'Bars'.
  - Keep labels on screen - When the Playlist is scrolling, Clip labels are slid along the Clips to keep them in view as long as possible before the Clip disappears to the left.
  - Content in title bars - Displays Clip contents when in 'Tile' mode, activated by vertical zoom setting.
  - Behind clips - Choose the background shading of Clips.
    - Nothing - Clips are transparent.
    - Plain - Clips lightly colored on their background.

- Cel - Clips show a hint of color on their background.
- Glass - Reflections from top and bottom.
- Aqua - Reflections from top.
- Solid - Solid color on background.
- Shadow - Adds a shadow beneath Clips.
- Resize all tracks - Choose from 33% to 200% to resize all Playlist tracks to the selected size.
- Hide collapsed grouped tracks - Collapsed grouped tracks will be hidden. A small arrow will appear on the right side of the track header to open/close the group.
- Show fade previews - When [Audio Clip Envelopes](#) are used, the waveform will reflect level changes caused by the envelope. Deselect 'fade previews' when this view mode interferes with your ability to see important information in the waveform. TIP: When deselected hold (Alt) for temporary previews.
- Show gain value - Shows the gain value badge at all times, if the value was changed from the default dB.
- Show gain scale - Determines if the audio will scale visually as Clip gain is adjusted.
- Show gain previews - When [Audio Clip Envelopes](#) are used, the waveform will reflect level changes caused by the Gain control. Deselect 'gain previews' when this view mode interferes with your ability to see important information in the waveform. TIP: When deselected hold (Alt) for temporary previews.
- Incremental scrolling - The Scroll-bar position will move slowly, rather than jumping to the precise location, when you click on the Scroll Bar rail. To move the Scroll-handle quickly, click on it and drag.
- Precise time indicator - A vertical line is drawn through the editor window to show playback and edit position.
- Performance clip progress - In Performance mode, Clip play-progress is animated on active Clips as a horizontal bar.
- Performance track progress - In Performance mode, track play-progress is indicated on the Playlist track header as a shaded clock animation.
- Mini playlist preview - Shows a context aware preview of Clips, in the Playlist, on the Scroll bar. Sub-options include:
  - Enable - Show the mini-preview.
  - Double height - Doubles the vertical space to show the preview.

- Show time markers - Time markers show as orange triangles along the preview bar.
- Show controls on audio tracks - Display [Recording controls](#) on Audio Tracks.
- Show levels on audio tracks - The track activity indicators show as peak-meters.
- Show levels on instrument tracks - The track activity indicators show as peak-meters.
- Remove background picture - You can drag-and-drop .png format images on the Playlist to create a background image. Use this to remove them.
- Snap - Snap determines how events will move relative to the Playlist grid and how quantization aligns events (NOTE: holding the Alt key temporarily sets snap to 'none'). The options are:
  - Main - Snap is set to the [Global snap](#) value.
  - Line - Clips snap to the nearest grid-line, notice that the grid changes resolution as the Playlist is Zoomed horizontally.
  - Cell - Clips snap to the start of the grid-cell they fall in.
  - (none) - No snapping. Movement is limited only by the [Project Timebase \(PPQ\) setting](#) (F11). NOTE: Snapping can be temporarily disabled by holding the Alt key when dragging Clips.
  - Steps 1/6 to 1 (step) - Absolute grid values equal to the nominated fraction of a step.
  - Beats 1/6 to 1 (beat) - Absolute beats values equal to the nominated fraction of a beat.
  - Bar - 1 bar.
  - Events - Relative to existing events. This is useful to show the boundaries of sliced events when they are butted against each other, as events surrounding the selected event change color.
- Select - Making selections:
  - Deselect (Ctrl+D) - Undo any selection.
  - Select all (Ctrl+A) - Selects all Clips.
  - Select by selected source (Shift+C) - Selects all Pattern Clips associated with the currently selected source Clip in the [Picker Panel](#).
  - Select muted - Select all Clips that have been muted (by the mute selection tool). NOTE: You can use the shortcuts (Alt/Opt+M) and (Alt/Opt+Shift+M) to Mute

and Unmute selections.

- **Select overlapping clips** - Selects all but the lowest Clips that are overlapping. This includes any degree of overlap up to and including 100%.
- **Select stacked clips** - Selects all but the lowest Clips that are 100% overlapped. This is useful to find those editing mistakes. 100% overlapped Clips will often sound louder than non-overlapped instances.
- **Invert selection** - (Shift+I) Inverts the selection (what was selected is now deselected and what was deselected is now selected).
- **Select time around selection** (Ctrl+Enter) - Sets the time-line selection to match the length of the currently selected clip(s). If no selection is made the Zoomed range will be selected.
- **Select previous time** (Ctrl+Left arrow) - Shifts a selection (made by Ctrl+Left-click and swiping the time-bar) by its own width to the right.
- **Select next time** (Ctrl+Right arrow) - Shifts a selection (made by Ctrl+Left-click and swiping the time-bar) by its own width to the left.
- **Group** - Make a selection then use the following:
  - **Group** - (Shift+G) - Group selected Clips. Grouping functions so that selecting, moving or deleting any Clip in a group will cause all others notes in the group to be selected, moved or deleted, etc. Any number of groupings may be created. To group Clips: make a selection using the  Select tool, then use the Group function. Activated / deactivate grouping: Use the Note / Pattern Grouping switch on the [Toolbar shortcut icons](#). Deselecting the Note / Pattern Grouping switch will disable note grouping behavior until the switch is reactivated.
  - **Ungroup** - (Alt/Opt+G) - Ungroup selected notes. Select one Clip in the group then use this function to ungroup all Clips in the group.
- **Zoom** - Contains a submenu with a set of quick zooming levels:
  - **Zoom in/ Zoom out** (Page up / Page down) - Zoom centers on the Cursor position.
  - **Quick-zoom 1, 2 & 3** (Shift+1, 2, 3) - Three handy zoom levels.
  - **Zoom out far** (Shift+4) - Minimum horizontal zoom.
  - **Zoom on selection** (Shift+5) - Zoom to time-line selection. The command will be disabled if no time region is selected in the timeline.
  - **Zoom on performance clips** (Shift+6) - Zoom to the Performance zone in the Playlist.

- **Time markers** - Markers can be used to label parts of your song (such as 'chorus' for example), define regions or to change live Playlist playback behavior. Playlist menu options are:
  - **Add marker... (Alt/Opt+T)** - Add a time marker above the time-line. Type a name for the marker and press Enter. The marker can be dragged into the correct location after naming. If the project already has markers, then Right-Click a marker and select Add new marker from the pop-up menu. NOTE: Time markers are used to annotate the Playlist and can also serve as live performance points (see marker type below).
  - **Add auto (Ctrl+T)** - Adds a time marker named 'Auto' ready to be edited.
  - **Add two** - Make a time-line selection and use this option. Markers will be added at the start and end of the selection.
  - **Add one every** - Select from Bar, 2 bars, 4 bars or 8 bars. You must make a time-line selection first.
  - **Add jump to next bar** - Adds a marker of type Jump to the next bar (Skips to the next marker after that).
  - **[Add time signature change...](#) (Shift+Alt/Opt+T)** - If a selection is made, the Time signature will apply for the selection. A second markers is added, reverting the Time signature to the setting before the selection.
  - **Place loop (Shift+T)** - Adds a loop return Time Marker.
  - **Delete** - Delete the marker/s in the time-line selection. If no selection is made then all markers are deleted.
  - **Change marker to loop** - Changes the marker/s in the time-line selection to the Loop type. If no selection is made then all markers are changed to loop. Right-Click markers to choose other marker types.
  - **Start recording/Stop recording at selection** - Adds start/stop recording markers to the selection. These automate the main Recording control on/off.

#### Marker/lane right-click menu:

- **Add marker... (Alt/Opt+T)** - Add a time marker above the time-line. Type a name for the marker and press Enter. The marker can be dragged into the correct location after naming. If the project already has markers, then Right-Click a marker and select Add new marker from the pop-up menu. NOTE: Time markers are used to annotate the Playlist and can also serve as live performance points (see marker type below).
- **[Add time signature...](#) (Shift+Alt/Opt+T)** - If a selection is made, the Time signature



will apply for the selection. A second markers is added, reverting the Time signature to the setting before the selection.

- Place loop (Shift+T) - Adds a loop return Time Marker.
- Delete - Delete the marker/s in the time-line selection. If no selection is made then all markers are deleted.
- Rename... - Edit the name at the pop-up name dialog and press enter.
- Move content left / right - This option moves this content to the left or right of the next markers content region. A markers 'content' is defined as those Clips between the current marker and the next. NOTE: Selecting the menu option View > Time segments > Markers will display marker region/s by shading the Playlist.

Action - Set the Markers purpose:

- None - The marker has no effect. Default type used where markers are just labels.
- Start - Playback and time = 0 starts from the set point.
- Loop - Playback will return to this marker when the end of all data in the Playlist is reached. NOTE: Placing this marker type beyond the end of the last data will also cause FL Studio to render to that point.
- Marker loop - When the playback reaches the next marker playback will jump back to the Loop marker creating a loop.
- Marker skip - Playback will jump to the next marker skipping any Playlist data between them.
- Marker pause - Playback will Pause unless the preceding marker is the Loop type.
- [Time signature](#) - Set a Time signature to start from this point.
- Start recording / Stop recording - Automates the main recording button on and off respectively.

NOTE: Check the Playlist Menu option View > Time segments > Markers to see the Playlist grid shaded by marker region.

Working with Time Markers

- Reposition a marker - Left-click and drag the marker from its left-most edge and release when desired. Markers can be dragged past existing markers without disturbing them.
- Using the time line - Right-Click on the time line to add a marker at the desired location and select 'Add marker'.

Live song jumps - You can using a MIDI keyboard, typing keyboard shortcuts (see below) or FF/RW [transport keys](#) on a multimedia keyboard to jump between time markers to create innovative live performances. [▶ Video tutorial here.](#) To use a MIDI keyboard:

- Set the [MIDI options 'Song marker jump MIDI channel'](#) to the same MIDI channel as your controller. NOTE: To play plugin instruments just use different MIDI channel to the '[Song marker jump MIDI channel](#)'.
- Turn OFF the Audio Option '[Reset Plugins on Transport](#)'. This should give a faster and less glitchy response when jumping and moving the song position marker.
- Turn ON the Audio Option '[Play truncated notes](#)'. This ensures any notes started before a jump point, and crossing it, still play.
- Select 'Live mode' from the [Playlist menu](#). This changes the jump-to behavior so that jumps happen on bar divisions and also shows the jump-to points (as a gray position marker).

NOTE: Link the [Channel mute switches](#) to buttons on your MIDI controller to mute and unmute instruments during a performance for added variation.

Once markers have been added and their type defined they will respond as follows:

| Marker 1 | Marker 2 | Marker 3 | Marker 4 |
|----------|----------|----------|----------|
| ( Start  | ↓ Loop   | II Pause | ▶ Skip   |

  

| Playlist |                                                  |
|----------|--------------------------------------------------|
|          | Deselect region (Same as A#4)                    |
|          | Live select (  End)                              |
|          | Add marker                                       |
|          | Jump to next bar (  *)                           |
|          | Jump to previous bar (  /)                       |
| Marker 9 |                                                  |
| Marker 8 | C5                                               |
| Marker 7 | Deselect region (Same as A#5)                    |
| Marker 6 | Select next marker region (  Ctrl+Alt+*) x 2     |
| Marker 5 | Select previous marker region (  Ctrl+Alt+/) x 2 |
| Marker 4 |                                                  |
| Marker 3 | Jump to next marker (  Alt + *)                  |
| Marker 2 | Jump to previous marker (  Alt + /)              |
| Marker 1 | C4                                               |

NOTE: Keyboard shortcuts apply to the Number Pad only.

- Picker panel - Shows all Pattern, Audio and Automation Clips used in the project. See

the [Picker Panel](#) section for more details.

- **Enable** - Show/hide the Picker Panel.
- **Show on right side** - Moves the Picker Panel to the right side of the Playlist.
- **Width** - Select a predefined Picker Panel width.
- **Select linked channels** - Channels associated with the selected Clip will be selected in the Channel Rack.
- **Select from playlist/channel rack** - Clicking Clips in the Playlist will select them in the Picker Panel.
- **Show empty patterns** - Shows empty patterns in the Picker Panel.
- **Drag to rearrange** - Allows you to click and drag on Clips to rearrange them.
- **Auto group patterns/channels** - When using 'Clone' and 'Make Unique' commands, keeps the copies in the same Groups as the source Clips.
- **Select unused** - Select unused Pattern, Audio or Automation Clips. Unused Clips are those not placed in the Playlist.
- **Sort** - Sort Pattern, Audio or Automation Clips by Name, Color, Mixer track etc, depending on what is appropriate for the Clip type.
- **Current Clip source** - Shows the list of Clips available in the project. The currently selected Clip will be highlighted.
- **Edit patterns in** - Choose what double-clicking a Pattern Clip does...
  - **Automatic** - Open the Piano roll if the pattern has any Piano roll notes or open the Event Editor if there's only Event Automation, otherwise open the Channel Rack.
  - **Channel rack** - Open the Channel rack.
  - **Piano roll** - Open the Piano roll. NOTE: Where you click on the Pattern Clip will determine where horizontally the Piano roll is scrolled when opened.
  - **Piano roll or event editor** - If there is note data, the Piano roll will be used. If there is only Event data, the Event Editor will be used.
  - **Adjust start time** - When enabled: The Piano roll will open and scroll to the Bar that you clicked on. When disabled: The Piano roll will always open scrolled to the start.

NOTE: (Alt/Opt+Double-Click) will open the Channel rack when the Piano roll is selected, and the Piano roll when the Channel Rack is selected, that is, use the opposite action.

- **Performance mode (Ctrl+P)** - Performance mode is designed to trigger and loop individual Playlist tracks and Clips to create live performances. Performance mode is explained in

detail [here](#).

- **Quantize song jumps** - When manually relocating the Play head, FL Studio will wait before jumping to a new location. Choose Off, Beats, Bars (1 to 8). The relocation event is set on mouse-button release. NOTE: Quantizing song jumps can help to keep tempo synced effects in time with the project so you can jump around and maintain musicality. If you relocate the Play Head and FL Studio does not immediately play, this will likely be the cause.
- **Center (Shift+0)** - Center (grid) centers the Playlist's grid so the play position marker is in the middle. Useful when you want to see the playing position in a long sequence.
- **Detached** - Detaches the Playlist from the FL Studio workspace, allowing it to be dragged to another monitor.